

Yi Zhong

yeszhong@umich.edu • [Google Scholar](#) • [GitHub](#) • (+1) 734-465-0449

EDUCATION

University of Michigan , Ann Arbor B.S.E. in Computer Science	August 2025 - May 2027(Expected)
Shanghai Jiao Tong University , Shanghai B.S.E. in Electrical and Computer Engineering	September 2023 - August 2027(Expected)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Video Generative Model, World Model, Robot Learning

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Jun Gao Lab , UMich • Advisor: Jun Gao • Video generation models, world action models • Open-world object affordance prediction	January 2026 – Present
SIRIUS Lab , SJTU • Advisor: Yutong Ban • Focused on the intersection of Computer Vision, Robotics and Surgical Data Science • Constructed image-based vision methods for robot state estimation	May 2025 – September 2025
DeepEnergy Lab , SJTU • Advisor: Jiayu Wan, Yang Liu • Built the LLM-Agent and RAG system, powering the team's vertical-domain AI4Science applications	February 2024 – September 2025

PUBLICATIONS

*: Authors with equal contribution.

- [1] **AFUN: Towards an Affordance Foundation Model for Functionality Understanding.**
arXiv preprint, 2026.
Zhaoning Wang*, Yi Zhong*, Jiawei Fu, Henrik I. Christensen, Jun Gao
- [2] **Synthesis-GPT: An Intelligent Assistant for Solid-State Electrolyte Synthesis.**
Small Structures, 2026.
Boyue Li, Peiyi Li, Yi Zhong, Zixian Yan, Zhaoxin Yu, Ziyang Ning, Chuying Ouyang, Xihao Chen, Haizu Jin, Yang Liu, Jiayu Wan
- [3] **Breaking Interdisciplinary Barriers in Solid-State Battery Research: The BatteryAgent for Multifaceted Analysis.**
Journal of Materials Chemistry A, 2025. (Selected as **2025 HOT Paper**)
Yi Zhong*, Yan Leng*, Zhi Gu, Shujing Guo, Peiyi Li, Das Soham, Yankehao Liu, Jiayu Wan, Yang Liu
- [4] **Intelligent, Personalized Scientific Assistant via Large Language Models for Solid-State Battery Research.**
ACS Materials Letters, 2025.
Yan Leng, Yi Zhong, Zhi Gu, Peiyi Li, Haoting Cui, Xing Li, Yang Liu, Jiayu Wan
- [5] **Accelerating Battery Research with Retrieval-Augmented Large Language Models: Present and Future.**
Energy Storage Science and Technology, 2024.
Yi Zhong, Yan Leng, Sihui Chen, Peiyi Li, Zhi Zou, Yang Liu, Jiayu Wan

HONORS & AWARDS

The Jackson and Muriel Lum Scholarship	July, 2025
Class of 2009 SEIEE Alumni Scholarship	December, 2024
2023-2024 SJTU Undergraduate Excellent Scholarship	December, 2024
Future Scholar of Global Institute of Future Technology Award	July, 2024